

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - September 26, 2026

Compiled summary for Saturday, September 26, 2026 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio after the September 21 About Dev methodology pass, verifying the United States Eastern date, running the customary project reader, extracting and studying all forty pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs, booting the local Next.js site, bringing the established Alla Vostra UI Foundations / UX Product Flow switcher language into the Cinerific project page, creating a Cinerific-specific client-side switcher, preserving the existing Cinerific screenshots and media assets, rebuilding the Cinerific UX overview as a responsive DOM-based flow diagram, iterating its section taxonomy and screen-node layout, validating sticky behavior and responsive geometry, documenting committed source state 0bc5100, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, and generating the September 26 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_september21.pdf and after the September 21 documentation state. The source state reviewed for this record is 0bc51006b002650537408ec7d0321fc67c145e56 on main, matching origin/main, titled Refined the Cinerific product-flow navigation and diagram. The source commit contains app/globals.css, app/projects/cinerific/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/projects/cinerific/page.tsx, and portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt. No Hostinger deploy-branch work or production deployment was performed during this PDF-generation pass. The local documentation deltas created after the source commit are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file and this September 26 root-level PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date with TZ=America/New_York date from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio. It reported Saturday, September 26, 2026 at 10:18 PM EDT with UTC offset -0400, so the worklog uses September 26 rather than the UTC calendar date.
- Ran ./read_project.sh and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before composing this record, preserving the Portfolio convention that the current tree, configuration, assets, PDF inventory, Git context, and standing workflow instructions are refreshed for session documentation.
- Extracted and studied all forty pre-existing root-level Portfolio worklog PDFs with pdftotext: fifteen July records, fifteen August records, and ten September records through portfolio_worklog_september21.pdf. The review covered 236 PDF pages and approximately 110,002 extracted words.
- Compared the complete series for title cadence, root-level filename conventions, same-day part suffixes, opening-summary density, source-material language, baseline and goal framing, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation wording, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, and output-artifact closure.
- Used portfolio_worklog_september21.pdf as the closest chronological and metadata baseline, while the August 3, August 16, September 8 Part 2, September 9, and September 11 records supplied the closest history for Product Flow switchers, diagram geometry, sticky behavior, responsive validation, and local-cache handling.
- Checked pdftinfo and pdfinfo on the September 21 baseline. The mature output convention remains US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, no encryption, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, and a repeated page footer.
- Reviewed commit 0bc5100 through git show, git log, git status, branch tracking, and the complete changed-file set. Confirmed main and origin/main both resolve to the same commit and the source worktree was clean before the customary snapshot refresh.
- Reviewed the active Cinerific implementation in app/projects/cinerific/page.tsx and app/projects/cinerific/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, the shared Product Flow treatment in app/globals.css, and the Alla Vostra switcher implementation used as the visual and behavioral reference.

Baseline Status Before September 26 Work

- The Cinerific project route already existed as a detailed mobile-commerce case-study page with a hero, Overview, Scope and Ownership, Core Features, Product Flow, technical architecture, engineering decisions, release-readiness content, stack, proof, and closing contact surfaces.
- Its Product Flow section still used a static six-item stage strip labeled Launch, Browse, Cart, Details, Payment, and Confirmation, followed by an empty launch-frame treatment, explanatory copy, and the existing expandable screenshot groups.
- Cinerific had no UI Foundations / UX Product Flow switcher. The equivalent Alla Vostra section already had an accepted two-tab glass navigation surface, active/inactive states, fixed-on-scroll behavior scoped to the Product Flow region, hash-aware view selection, and responsive sizing.
- The user wanted the switcher shell and behavior transferred first without changing any Cinerific image asset, screenshot source, or existing expandable screenshot group. UI Foundations was intentionally reserved as an empty state for later work.
- The Cinerific UX overview did not yet have the dark grid, green vertical section rails, hairline separators, coordinate-driven screen nodes, or responsive diagram vocabulary already established on the Alla Vostra page.
- The local Next.js development workflow remained sensitive to stale Turbopack CSS after production/static builds, so generated .next output needed recoverable cache moves and clean server restarts during visual verification.

Goals for September 26

- Add the Alla Vostra UI Foundations / UX Product Flow navigation look and interaction model to the Cinerific Product Flow section while preserving Cinerific-specific content boundaries.
- Keep UX Product Flow as the default view, retain every existing Cinerific screenshot group beneath the new overview, and expose an intentionally empty UI Foundations view with no imported or invented assets.
- Preserve the shared glass surfaces, active/inactive button hierarchy, responsive typography, safe-area-aware pinned placement, section-bounded sticky behavior, hash selection, and smooth reduced-motion-aware scroll correction.
- Replace the old Cinerific stage strip and launch placeholder with a DOM-based UX diagram that uses the accepted Alla Vostra grid, panel, green rails, dark nodes, separators, and coordinate system.
- Iterate the diagram taxonomy to the accepted final section sequence: Welcome, Preview, Browse Selection, Favorites, and Settings, with Browse Selection occupying approximately two standard section heights.
- Populate Welcome, Preview, and Browse Selection with the requested screen names and controls while leaving Favorites and Settings available for later node definition.
- Keep diagram labels, boxes, rows, and spacing legible without clipping, collision, or document-level overflow at desktop, tablet, phone, and 320px narrow widths.
- Run TypeScript, browser geometry, local route, and static-export checks, preserve repository route metadata after build side effects, refresh the snapshot, and document the committed result in the established PDF format.

Work Completed - Cinerific Product Flow Switcher

- Added app/projects/cinerific/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx as a dedicated client component and wrapped the existing Cinerific flow-capture groups from app/projects/cinerific/page.tsx without changing their screenshot data, image paths, ordering, or expansion controls.
- Reused the global product-flow-nav class system so Cinerific inherits the same restrained glass material, two-column tab geometry, active dark-green state, translucent inactive state, borders, highlights, typography, and phone-width resizing as Alla Vostra.
- Set UX Product Flow as the initial view and added an empty UI Foundations state containing only its section heading. No Cinerific visual asset was added, replaced, recolored, or removed for the empty state.

- Added hash-aware initialization and hashchange handling for #ui-foundations and #ux-product-flow so direct navigation can select the appropriate Cinerific view.
- Implemented measured pinned behavior with ResizeObserver and CSS custom properties for fixed left position, fixed width, and measured height, keeping the tab bar aligned with the site shell rather than the viewport edge.
- Scoped the sticky state to #product-flow. The navigation pins after its anchor reaches the viewport and returns to normal flow before its bottom would pass the Product Flow section boundary.
- Added post-switch scroll correction that accounts for the navigation height, runs after the new view renders, repeats once after layout settles, uses smooth motion by default, and respects prefers-reduced-motion.
- Removed the obsolete flowSegments array and launchScreen placeholder from the Cinerific page after the new diagram replaced the old six-stage strip and launch/introduction layout.

Work Completed - Responsive UX Product Flow Diagram

- Built the Cinerific diagram with the same coordinate-driven DOM approach as Alla Vostra: a dark green grid plane, translucent panel layer, vertical green rails, horizontal hairline dividers, dark outlined nodes, and percentage-based geometry derived from one coordinate frame.
- Added Cinerific-specific CSS for the diagram canvas height while retaining the shared flow-table frame, background, rail, divider, and node styling. The diagram remains aligned with the existing single-column Product Flow presentation.
- Removed the initially considered Tutorial/Intro, Checkout, Confirmation, and Navigate rails as the flow taxonomy evolved, then shifted all surviving sections upward so the diagram contains no abandoned blank row.
- Settled the final green rail sequence on Welcome, Preview, Browse Selection, Favorites, and Settings. Increased Cinerific rail-label typography by exactly twenty-five percent, from the shared 12px treatment to 15px, without changing rail dimensions or coordinates.
- Merged the temporary Movies and Shows rails into one Browse Selection rail and preserved approximately their combined vertical height. Removed the internal divider between those former sections while retaining the surrounding section separators.
- Kept Favorites and Settings as empty diagram sections for later flow definition instead of inventing screen names or reusing unrelated Cinerific content.
- Made dark-node typography responsive with a scoped clamp, removed minimum-content width pressure, and allowed safe text wrapping on narrow screens without altering the global Alla Vostra node treatment.

Work Completed - Screen Nodes and Browse Selection Taxonomy

- Built the final Welcome screen-node group with Hero, Create My Account, Sign In, and Forgot Username, replacing the earlier Splash wording with Hero while preserving the two-row arrangement.
- Added one centered Home node to Preview, keeping the green Preview rail separate from the screen name shown within that section.
- Added a top Browse Selection control row with Genre and Order, shortening the earlier Genre View and Order View labels without changing their box sizes or placement.
- Added the final selection rows as ALL, Action, Comedy, and Thriller on the first genre row, followed by Horror, Drama, Doc, and Romance on the second. Documentary was shortened to Doc, Romance moved to the bottom row, and ALL was added immediately before Action.
- Doubled the vertical gap between the Genre/Order row and the first genre row while keeping the established lower-row gap. Recentered the complete three-row group inside the tall Browse Selection section after each spacing change.
- Balanced both four-box genre rows horizontally and used one coordinate definition for the complete Browse Selection group, preventing divergent desktop and phone layouts.
- Changed node keys to include vertical coordinates so repeated screen labels can remain stable if future sections reuse a name without causing React key collisions.

- Preserved the existing expandable Cinerific screenshot groups below the diagram. Their captions, stage labels, collapse thresholds, Small/Large metadata, and image assets remain available exactly where they were before this pass.

Work Completed - Local Cache, Validation, and Commit Context

- Kept the local Next.js 16.2.10 Turbopack server available at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> and repeatedly checked `/projects/cinerific` during the navigation, diagram, label, and spacing passes.
- Cleared stale generated CSS state after static builds by stopping the dev server, moving `.next` into timestamped `/tmp/portfolio-next-cache.*` directories, and restarting from a clean cache. No user-authored source or asset was deleted.
- Ran browser-driven checks with the installed Chrome channel because the standalone Playwright Chromium bundle was not present. Used the same local route and real computed layout rather than relying only on source inspection.
- Recommended the final past-tense commit message with one header and three hyphen-led change points, then reviewed committed source `0bc5100` carrying the Cinerific switcher, diagram, styling, page integration, and refreshed snapshot.
- Confirmed the source commit contains 474 insertions and 78 deletions across four files, including the new 429-line `ProductFlowSwitcher` client component.
- Confirmed main and origin/main match at `0bc5100` before this documentation pass. No source commit, push, Hostinger operation, or public deployment was performed while generating this PDF.

Validation Summary

- `npm run check` passed repeatedly with `tsc --noEmit` after the switcher integration, diagram construction, taxonomy changes, node additions, label changes, and final spacing pass.
- `npm run build:static` passed with `NEXT_OUTPUT=export` next build, successfully compiling, type-checking, collecting page data, and generating all seven static pages. The route list included `/`, `/aboutdev`, `/articles`, `/projects/alla-vostra`, and `/projects/cinerific`.
- Restored `next-env.d.ts` from the production `.next/types` route reference to the repository's `.next/dev/types/routes.d.ts` convention after each static build changed the generated import.
- Verified the Cinerific route returned HTTP 200 from the local server after implementation, cache resets, and static-export validation.
- Verified the switcher at 1440px and 390px: UX Product Flow was selected by default, UI Foundations switched to an asset-free empty state, UX restored the existing content, and both buttons reported the correct aria-pressed state.
- Verified sticky behavior by scrolling inside Product Flow and then beyond it: the navigation used fixed positioning while inside the section and returned to static positioning after the section boundary.
- Verified the final diagram at 1440px, 390px, and 320px. The page reported zero document-level horizontal overflow, no node overlap, no clipped node content, no clipped rail labels, and stable section dividers.
- Measured the doubled Browse Selection spacing in the rendered browser. The Genre/Order-to-first-genre-row gap was approximately 53.6px, while the lower genre-row gap remained approximately 26.8px.
- Confirmed the final rails are Welcome, Preview, Browse Selection, Favorites, and Settings; the final populated nodes are Hero, Create My Account, Sign In, Forgot Username, Home, Genre, Order, ALL, Action, Comedy, Thriller, Horror, Drama, Doc, and Romance.
- Ran `git diff --check` during the source work and found no whitespace errors. Confirmed no public image or Cinerific screenshot asset appeared in the committed changed-file set.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- `app/projects/cinerific/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx` - added the Cinerific client-side view switcher, hash synchronization, section-bounded sticky measurements, scroll correction, diagram coordinate system, final rails, dividers, and screen nodes.

- app/projects/cinerific/page.tsx - imported the switcher, wrapped the existing expandable screenshot groups, and removed the superseded static flow-stage strip and launch placeholder data.
- app/globals.css - added Cinerific diagram canvas sizing, the twenty-five-percent rail-label increase, and scoped responsive node text rules for narrow layouts.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed through ./read_project.sh for the September 26 documentation pass so it records the current project tree, source commit, PDF inventory, and Git context.
- portfolio_worklog_september26.pdf - generated as this new root-level dated Portfolio documentation artifact. No Cinerific PNG, JPG, SVG, or screenshot asset was modified.

Follow-Up Context

- UI Foundations is intentionally empty. Future work can populate it without changing the accepted switcher, sticky behavior, hashes, or preserved UX screenshot groups.
- Favorites and Settings are intentionally empty green sections in the diagram. Add dark screen nodes only when their real Cinerific screens and naming are defined.
- Browse Selection intentionally spans roughly two standard rail heights. Its three node rows are centered as one group, with a doubled first gap and the original lower gap.
- The Cinerific node font override is scoped. Future global Alla Vostra diagram changes should not remove the narrow-layout wrapping and minimum-width safeguards required by the Cinerific labels.
- The existing screenshot groups remain below the new diagram even where their legacy stage language is broader than the overview taxonomy. Future content edits should distinguish diagram navigation from screenshot-capture organization.
- If the local preview serves old CSS after another production build, stop the dev server, move .next to a recoverable /tmp directory, and restart before modifying valid source styles.
- The current source is committed at 0bc5100 and matches origin/main. This PDF and the refreshed snapshot are documentation artifacts created after that source commit.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for the commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly supplies the message and requests the operation.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_september26.pdf.
- Used the established filename because this is the first Portfolio worklog for September 26, 2026; no Part suffix was needed.
- Produced a US Letter, PDF 1.4, unencrypted document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, section ordering, repeated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: 0bc51006b002650537408ec7d0321fc67c145e56 on main and origin/main.
- No source commit, push, deploy, Hostinger synchronization, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.